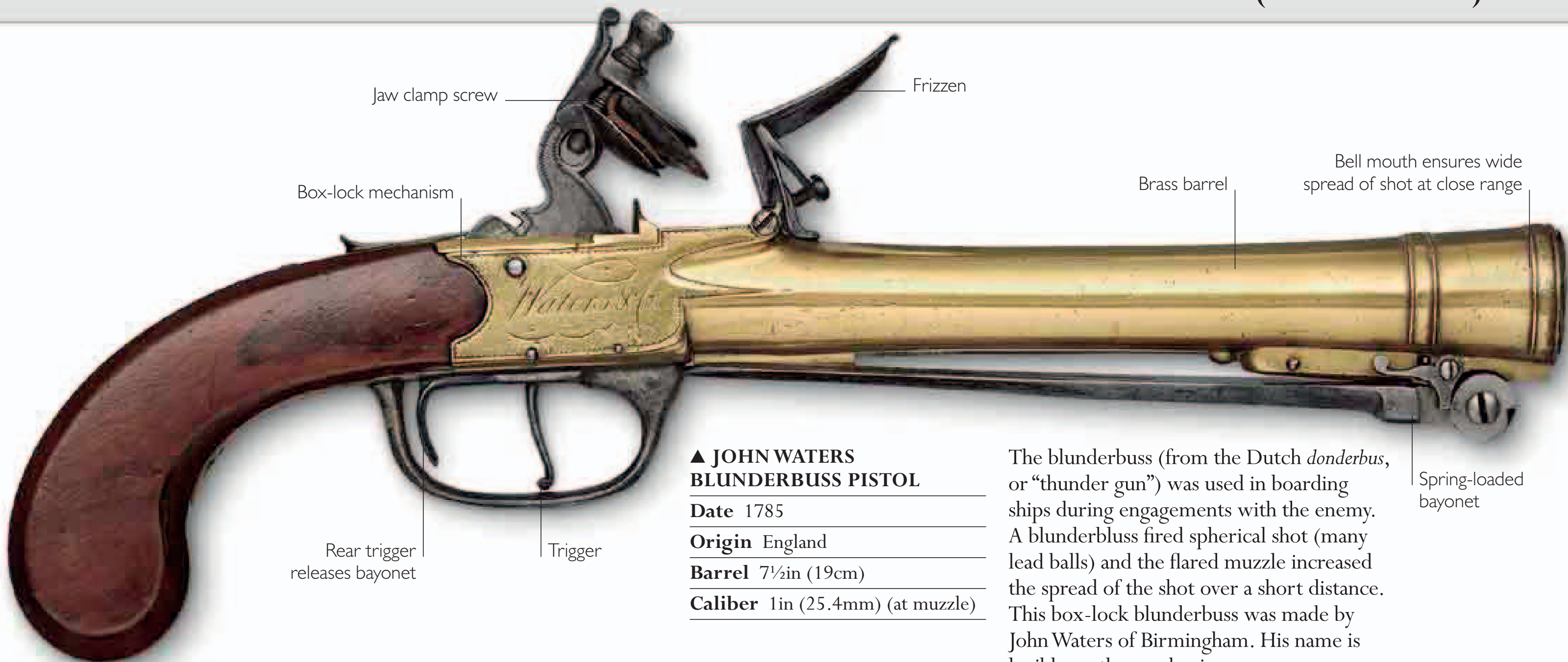


▲ JOHN WATERS BLUNDERBUSS PISTOL

Date 1785

Origin England

Barrel 7½in (19cm)

Caliber 1in (25.4mm) (at muzzle)

The blunderbuss (from the Dutch *donderbus*, or "thunder gun") was used in boarding ships during engagements with the enemy. A blunderbluss fired spherical shot (many lead balls) and the flared muzzle increased the spread of the shot over a short distance. This box-lock blunderbuss was made by John Waters of Birmingham. His name is legible on the mechanism.

▲ PUNJABI FLINTLOCK PISTOL

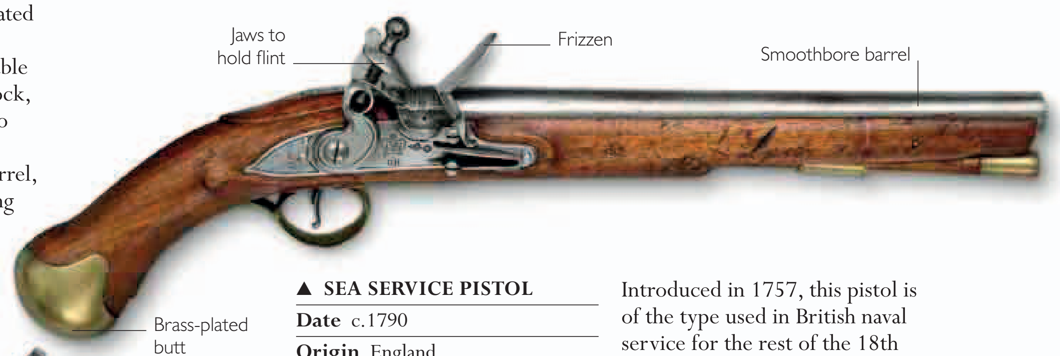
Date c.1800

Origin Lahore (in modern-day Pakistan)

Barrel 8½in (21.5cm)

Caliber .55in (14mm)

This is one of a pair of superbly decorated pistols made in Lahore. By the early 19th century, Sikh gunmakers were able to fashion the components of a flintlock, although they were mostly devoted to making workaday muskets known as *jazails*. This pistol has a "Damascus" barrel, formed by a process of pattern-welding in which spirally welded tubes were made from specially prepared strips of iron.



▲ SEA SERVICE PISTOL

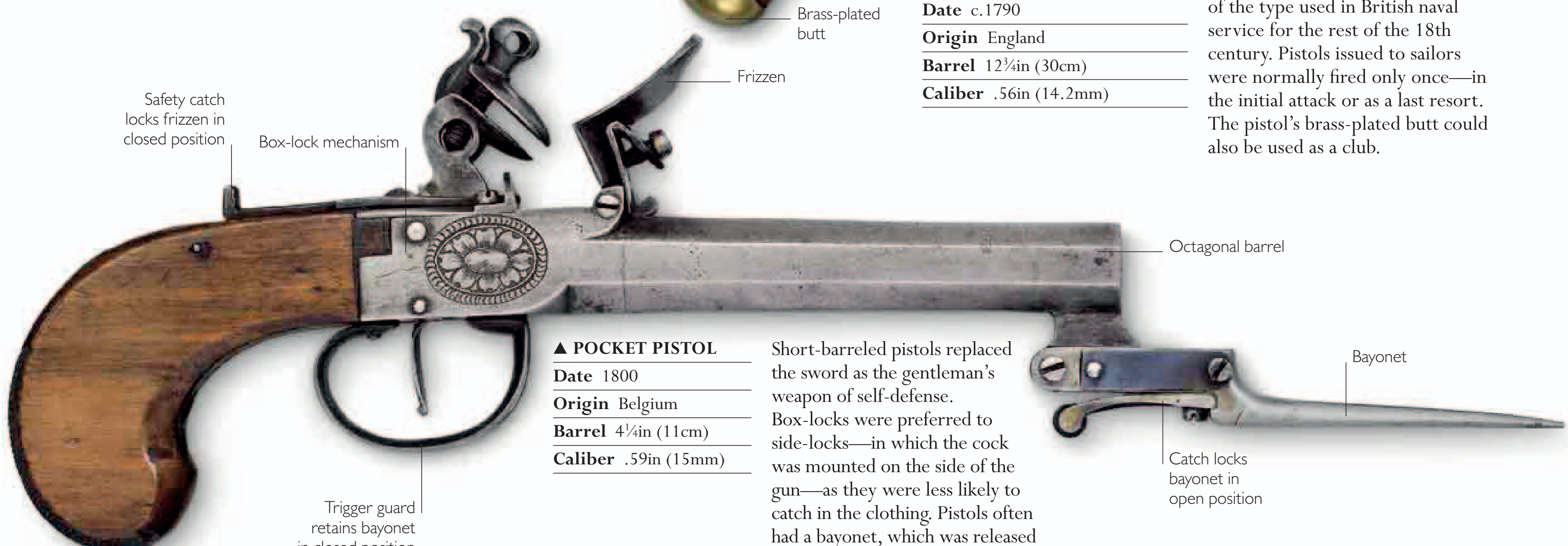
Date c.1790

Origin England

Barrel 12¾in (30cm)

Caliber .56in (14.2mm)

Introduced in 1757, this pistol is of the type used in British naval service for the rest of the 18th century. Pistols issued to sailors were normally fired only once—in the initial attack or as a last resort. The pistol's brass-plated butt could also be used as a club.



▲ POCKET PISTOL

Date 1800

Origin Belgium

Barrel 4¼in (11cm)

Caliber .59in (15mm)

Short-barreled pistols replaced the sword as the gentleman's weapon of self-defense. Box-locks were preferred to side-locks—in which the cock was mounted on the side of the gun—as they were less likely to catch in the clothing. Pistols often had a bayonet, which was released by pulling back the trigger guard.